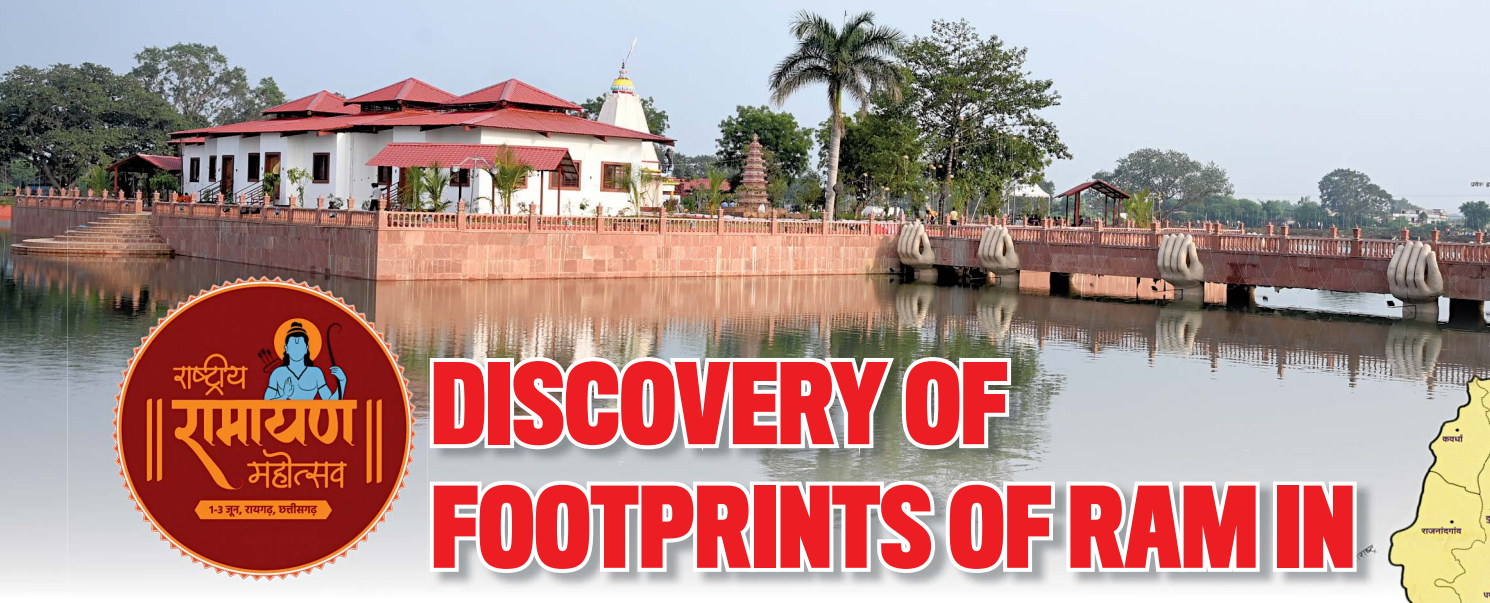


राष्ट्रीय रामायण महोत्सव
1-3 जून, रायगढ़, छत्तीसगढ़

DISCOVERY OF FOOTPRINTS OF RAM IN CHHATTISGARH



Ram, not just a name here... is a symbol of faith, belief, devotion, affinity, courage, strength, dignity and self-respect. Along with the name of Ram, many glimpses of his personality are also seen in the people here. This is the birthplace of Mata Kaushalya and the 'Nanihal' maternal home of Shri Ram.

This is Chhattisgarh, which was known as 'Dakshina Kosala' in the Ramayana era. Mata Kaushalya's father Sukaushal was the king of this region. Due to this, even today the people of Chhattisgarh consider Lord Shri Ram as their 'nephew' and worship him in this form.

Keeping in view the unwavering faith in 'Ram' in the people here, the state government is developing the 2226 kilometer long Ram Van Gaman Tourism Circuit. A series of tourist pilgrimages are being developed here for those who have faith in Ram. In this episode, to spread the story of Ramayana, the first ever 'National Ramayana Festival' is going to be organized here in Raamleela Maidan of Raigarh district.

SITAMARHI- HARCHAUKA

In the north of Dakshina Kosala, this land became holy by the feet of Lord Shri Ram on the banks of Mawai river. Sitamarhi near Bharatpur in the newly formed Manendragarh Bharatpur Chirmiri district - Harchauka is considered to be the first stop of Ram ji's exile period in Chhattisgarh. There are 17 chambers in the caves on the banks of the river. Twelve Shivlings are installed in these chambers. This place is also famous by the name of Sita's kitchen.

RAMGARH

Ramgiri mountain is mentioned in ancient and historical texts. This Ram Giri mountain situated in Surguja district is now known as Ramgarh hill. The Sitabengra-Jogimara cave theater located near Udaipur is considered to be the oldest theater in the world. Here the rock paintings of prehistoric times are inscribed in the Jogimara cave. Sita ji spent some time here with Ram ji during the exile, hence the name of this cave was 'Sitabengra'.

SHIVRINARAYAN LOCATED IN JANJGIR-CHAMPA DISTRICT

Shivrinarayan is an ancient town in Chhattisgarh associated with Lord Shri Ram's faith. It is situated on the banks of Tridhara confluence of Mahanadi, Shivnath and Jonk rivers. According to legends, it is believed that this is where Shabari fed her false berries to Lord Shri Ram during the exile.

RAJIM

During his exile, Lord Shri Ram along with Mata Sita and Lakshmana had entered Rajim via Mahanadi route of Arang via Fingeshwar and Champaranya region. Rajim is an ancient town situated at the confluence of Mahanadi, Sondur and Pairi rivers. At that time it was called 'Padmavatipura'. While going to the forest, Ram ji had spent some time in the hermitage of 'Lomash Rishi'. 'Sita Vatika' is also located at this place. It is said that Mata Sita created this garden during her stay. Natural caves located



"The Government of Chhattisgarh is fully dedicated to the protection and promotion of the state's rich cultural and religious heritage. Shri Ram and Ramayana hold an integral place in our culture. In line with its ongoing efforts to preserve our heritage and strengthen our connection with Shriram, the state government has undertaken the renovation of the temple dedicated to Mata Kaushalya. Additionally, the annual Kaushalya Mahotsav is being celebrated. Along with this, the state government is also doing the work of developing the places related to Lord Shri Ram's journey as spiritual tourism spots and recognizing them as 'Ram Van Gaman Path'

— Bhupesh Baghel Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh